

December

16

755

Chinese uprising

During the Chinese Tang Dynasty, rebellious military officer An Lushan staged a revolt against chancellor Yang Guozhong. This caused an uprising that spread throughout China and left the ruling Tang Dynasty weakened and in turmoil.



Also on this day

1707 Mount Fuji in Japan erupted, throwing volcanic rock and ash all over the city of Edo (modern-day Tokyo), 100 km (62 miles) away.

1850 British ships and settlers arrived in New Zealand, after the Canterbury Association in the UK decided to establish a colony there.

1944 The Battle of the Bulge began when Germany launched its final major attack of World War II, in the Ardennes, Belgium.

Born this day

1932 Quentin Blake, British artist. He created instantly recognizable illustrations for more than 300 books, including those by children's author Roald Dahl.

1773 Boston Tea Party

Angry at having to pay taxes to the British parliament, US colonists protested by climbing aboard British ships in Boston Harbor and dropping about 300 chests filled with tea leaves into the water. This event became known as the Boston Tea Party.

